

Answer 17

Three Australian health priorities for Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander (ATSI) people include:

1. Genuine shared decision making and partnerships:

1. Embed partnerships and shared decision-making across the whole health, disability, and aged care systems.
2. Establish systems that support Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander communities in defining and achieving their own health and well-being goals.
3. Embed the leadership of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander peak organisations in policymaking across jurisdictions.
4. Embed regional and local partnerships and interlinkages with Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander organisations across broader sectors that impact health.

2. Social and Emotional Wellbeing:

1. Update and implement a strategic approach for social and emotional well-being.
2. Support ACCHS to deliver social and emotional wellbeing services.
3. Support the work of Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander organisations to provide leadership on healing and social and emotional wellbeing.
4. Implement training and other support across the whole health system to better understand and respond to social and emotional well-being in all aspects of life.

3. Chronic Disease Prevention and Management: Implementing strategies to reduce the prevalence of chronic conditions such as diabetes, cardiovascular disease, and kidney disease by

1. Enhance health literacy to support integrated health promotion,
2. Early intervention
3. Delivery of culturally safe and responsive healthcare services.

Reference:

Chang, E., & Johnson, A. (2022). Living with chronic illness and disability: Principles for nursing practice (4th ed.). Elsevier.

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Australian Government Department of Health. (2021). National Aboriginal and Torres Strait Islander Health Plan 2021-2031. Commonwealth of Australia.

<https://www.health.gov.au/resources/publications/national-aboriginal-and-torres-strait-islander-health-plan-2021-2031>